

..c) Reflexivism and Deconstruction in Post-modernism

Reflexivism and Deconstruction are tenets of post modernism. Post modernism (as Spiro says) is challenge to objectivity, science and human reason of the modernist era.

Reflexivism : Is the conscious self awareness by an anthropologist checking biases.

Emergence of reflexivity:- Malinowski's writing on Trobrianders were found to have racist and patriarchal tones. Anne Weiner pointed out in HER RESTUDIES.

Geertz stated that the study of culture has to be "emic" and not "outsider looking in".

Ex: Autoethnographies:- Victor Crapanzano says in "Hermes Dilemma and Hamlets Desire" that autoethnographies that are logs of self awareness need to be created.

Practicing reflexivity :- ① anthropologist must know the ideological behaviour ② must compare

with actual behaviour (iii) Must check bias

DECONSTRUCTION

Derrida in "Of Grammatology" says deconstruction of texts is needed:-

- 1) due to metanarratives [cannot give a definition]
- 2) Against structural approach [BINARY OPPOSITIONS leave out oppressed groups]
- 3) Has power and bias of researcher [with western, Colonial ideas]
- 4) POLYVOCALITY [truth is not absolute]

In this school, deconstruction of texts is done.

STRANGER AND FRIEND: Hortense

Poquiter: In this book he says that anthropologist is "never full time member" of the group. Thus bias and deconstruction and reflexivity is needed.

Criticism of Postmodern Thought:-

Greenfield says it casts doubt on science and truth itself. MSahlins said power has too much focus.

However, medical anthropology has benefited from these tenets for getting an INSIDER PERSPECTIVE.